

Margot Madina

I have a dual background in AI research for accessibility and corporate communications & event planning. I am seeking roles in which I can satisfy these two main interests.

Education

- 2022–Present **PhD in Computational Linguistics & Accessibility**, H_DA, Darmstadt (Germany).
 - Research in AI-based solutions for accessible written communication.
 - Lead end-to-end studies (ethics, recruitment, experiments) and synthesize findings into peer-reviewed articles and conference presentations.
 - Anticipated Graduation: January 2026.**
- 2022–Present **M.A. in Corporate Communications and Event Organization**, UOC, Barcelona (Spain - Remote).
 - Focus on strategic event management, stakeholder engagement, and corporate communications.
 - Align event logistics and messaging with brand objectives, needs, and budget.
- 2019–2021 **M.Sc. in Natural Language Processing**, UPV-EHU, San Sebastián (Spain).
 - Analyzed language and got to know the existing techniques and applications for computer language processing.
 - Master's thesis:** Evaluated Microsoft Azure's speech-to-text technology for speakers with dysarthria, combining technical assessment with user-centered research (large-scale human evaluations and surveys).
- 2013–2018 **B.A. in English Studies**, UPV-EHU, Vitoria-Gasteiz (Spain).
 - Foundation in linguistics, analytical writing, cultural awareness, and multilingual communication.
- 2018 **CELTA Certificate**, BRITISH STUDY CENTRE, Edinburgh (UK).
 - Intensive certification in pedagogical communication and instructional design.

Work Experience

- 2025–Present **Event Planner and Coordinator**, AF WEDDINGS AND EVENTS, Montreal.
 - Managed client communications and coordinated vendors, overseeing operational follow-ups, timelines, and logistics to ensure smooth execution of high-stakes events.
 - Managed budgets, vendor quotes, deposits, and invoicing; tracked expenses and ensured financial accuracy and deadlines.
- 2022–Present **Doctoral Researcher**, DARMSTADT UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES, Hybrid.
 - Research focused on automatic adaptation of texts into Easy-to-Read versions using AI-based tools.
 - Designed and applied comparative evaluations of alternative solutions (e.g., expert-produced vs AI-generated content), identifying systematic differences in user outcomes and preferences.
 - Synthesized qualitative and quantitative findings into clear insights, highlighting gaps between theoretical performance metrics and real-world user experience.
 - Worked in interdisciplinary teams and managed end-to-end research logistics, including ethics approval, recruitment, study execution, and communication of findings.
- 2022–Present **Lecturer**, DARMSTADT UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES, Hybrid.
 - Designed and taught a full-semester Machine Translation course across two semesters, incorporating practical Machine Translation and NLP tools, hands-on activities, and learner-centered assessment methods.
 - Supported instruction in a Semantics course by assisting during class sessions, answering student questions, and grading assessments, helping reinforce key concepts and clarify difficult material.
- 2017–2019 **English Teacher**, LONDON SCHOOL OF LANGUAGES, Urnieta (Spain).
 - Planned and delivered lessons for learners of different levels (K2 to B2) and abilities, including students with special educational needs.
 - Adapted pedagogical materials to individual learner profiles and learning goals.

Honors and Awards

- 2024 **Best presentation and paper at ICCHP Young Researchers' Consortium 2024.**
Easy-to-Read Language: Development of Linguistic Resources and Automatic Text Adaptation Tools

Professional Service and Volunteering

SHARED TASK ORGANIZATION

- 2025 **CLEARs: Challenge for Plain Language and Easy-to-Read Adaptation for Spanish texts.**
<https://sites.google.com/gcloud.ua.es/clears/>
IberLEF 2025

REVIEWING

- 2024 **Reviewer**, *Workshop on German Text Simplification & Readability Assessment (KlarText 2025)*.
2024 **Reviewer**, *Third Workshop on Text Simplification, Accessibility and Readability (TSAR 2024)*.
2023 **Reviewer**, *EMLNP'23*.
2023 **Reviewer**, *72 issue SEPLN journal*.

Selected Publications

- 2024 **Margot Madina**, Itziar Gonzalez-Dios, and Melanie Siegel. Towards reliable E2R texts: a proposal for standardized evaluation practices. In *International Conference on Computers Helping People with Special Needs*, pages 224–231. Springer, 2024.
- 2024 **Margot Madina**, Itziar Gonzalez-Dios, and Melanie Siegel. A preliminary study of ChatGPT for Spanish E2R text adaptation. In *Proceedings of the 2024 Joint International Conference on Computational Linguistics, Language Resources and Evaluation (LREC-COLING 2024)*, pages 1422–1434, 2024.
- 2022 **Margot Madina**, Inma Hernáez, and Eva Navas. Evaluation of STT Technology Performance for Spanish Dysarthric Speech: Description of a Pilot Experiment. *ICCHP-AAATE 2022 Open Access Compendium "Assistive Technology, Accessibility and (e) Inclusion" Part I*, 2022.

Skills & Competencies

Project Operations: Planned and delivered end-to-end projects in both research and live events, building timelines, coordinating stakeholders, and managing documentation and follow-ups.

Communication: I have turned my findings into peer-reviewed publications and presented this work at conferences across both NLP and accessibility communities. Professional fluency in **English, Spanish, and Basque**; intermediate proficiency in **French and German**

Accessibility & Inclusion: Applied research in accessible communication to create more inclusive information and experiences (digital and in-person).

Languages

Spanish (Native), **Basque** (Native), **English** (fluent, C2), **German** (upper intermediate, B2), **French** (intermediate, B1)

Additional Information

Class 5 driving license

Musical education

Canadian Open Work Permit